



WhatsApp clone in Flutter

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Time To Move On From Material Design

Now comes the challenging part with the WhatsApp cloning design that requires customization as per specific needs. The customization does not follow the rules of Material Design, therefore, you need to think out of the box for this part.

In this section, you can get plenty widget support from Top AppBar, Message widget and Rounded text input section.

Let's start from the TopAppBar to maintain the alignment with the design.

AppBar Customization

There are no issues when designing AppBar using Material Design AppBar since it has only one icon. But, with WhatsApp, you find that you need both the Back Button (←) and the CircleAvatar.

You need to put the CircleAvatar in the AppBar's 'leading' property. The challenge is that the Back button competes with the former icon for space. However, by mimicking the space for Avatar and using the "automaticallyImpleLeading" property, CircleAvatar can reclaim its space. But, in the process, the functionality of the back button for users to return to the chat list page may be hindered. Here, we need to work on the "Title" property.

It's ideal not to touch the AppBar 'leading' property in the beginning. This makes room for a Back button to be inserted whenever necessary in